

# Facebook unveils Timeline and Open Graph apps at f8 Developer Conference

Facebook CEO Mark Zuckerberg announced some brand new features which you will see on Facebook in the coming weeks, at the f8 Conference in San Francisco. Zuckerberg laid out Facebook's vision for the future of profiles on Facebook, integration of music streaming services, news aggregation and other content spotting on the web site.



Mark Zuckerberg introduces Timeline

The first feature that was unveiled was Timeline. This is a complete revamp of the website. Timeline is a new way to express yourself to the world. It aggregates all the content you have created and uploaded on Facebook in a nice flip book sort of way. The idea behind this being that a person is much more than his present status, according to Zuckerberg.

There is a central line which splits your screen into half and there are dots which expand on either side of the line to give information on the person. As you scroll down you will get to know about the major events from the person's life in the form of photos, videos, status updates,

apps, etc. This timeline goes back upto 2004 and then you have a 'Way Back' section where you can upload content from before 2004. Think baby pictures from your birth year, your award winning school essay, videos from your uncle's wedding, etc., all before 2004.

One interesting aspect of Timeline is the huge header image which it allows you to upload. Scrolling through the profile can also highlight aspects of the users personality. For instance, if you are a photographer or a musician, then you can put up a powerful header image which communicates that fact. You have complete control over who views your timeline.

Another feature Maps feature, which lets you view where all you have been all these years. This is possible thanks to the Facebook Places integration.

How many times have you wanted to check out an app and had to answer that pop up asking your permission? Well, Open Graph is a whole new category of apps which will allow you to add activity to your stream without addressing any unwanted prompts asking for permission. You will get a single Permissions page that will allow publishing of all the app related data on your timeline.

Pattern Recognition was a common theme in the key-



Facebook timeline

note of Zuckerberg. He plans to make sharing a seamless experience on Facebook. Stuff like streaming music, TV content and news sharing has been

around since ages. But Facebook with its new Open Graph app ecosystem, plans to collaborate with a lot of news websites, music streaming services and TV content streaming services to allow you to read news, watch TV and listen to music based on what your friends are doing. So if your friend is listening to a particular song, you will get an update in your Facebook ticker about the same, and you can start listening to that same track simultaneously provided you have the necessary app. **d**

## Airtel Broadband launches 'Smartbytes' additional data usage packs

Airtel Broadband customers irked about the fair usage policy and high-speed data transfer limits on their 'unlimited' plans might be happy to learn of the company's latest announcement. Now, instead of settling for a lower bandwidth after reaching their data usage limits, customers can purchase additional data usage packs called Smartbytes.

Airtel Smartbytes range from 1GB to 50GB and start from ₹99. Apart from "augmenting their high speed data transfer limit", Airtel Broadband customers will now have a way to track their monthly data usage, with notifications about their billing cycle and the amount of data left in their plan. Airtel already sends notifications to customers when they've reached 80% and 100% of their high speed data transfer limits.

To use the Airtel Smartbyte service, customers who've used more than 80% of their data transfer limit plan can log on to <http://airtel.in/smartbytes> via their Airtel DSL connection, and opt for their choice of additional data usage packs, which have been listed below with their pricing:

- 1GB for ₹99      10GB for ₹499
- 2GB for ₹159      20GB for ₹799
- 5GB for ₹299      50GB for ₹1,499